

# Brief Timeline of Regeneron ISEF Judging

This brief timeline of judge operations offers an overview of judging. Elsewhere on the *Judge Information Board* you will find documents providing a detailed schedule with times and locations, along with others giving a full explanation of each of the judging features enumerated here.

## Ten Days Prior to the Fair

All of the online project materials produced by the students will be published about ten days before the fair so that you may begin studying the projects in your category. Don't wait until the night before. That will not be enough time. You should review all projects because any of them may end up being considered for an award, and your opinion will be important.

## Tuesday Afternoon, Judge Registration Day, May 16, 2023

Beginning at noon, judges will register and receive their initial schedules of 13 interviews over the first 18 periods. Most judges will register in-person and then have access to the physical project displays with no students present. In-person registrants should visit not only the projects to which they have been assigned, but any other projects in their category they find of interest. All judges may select up to five projects that they would like to interview, but were not assigned to interview. These are known as "My5 Projects." Judges must select all of their "My5" projects prior to the first interview period on Wednesday. Judges registering online will have to select their "My5" projects on the basis of project materials available online.

## Tuesday Evening

Tuesday evening, you will meet with your fellow judges in your category's assigned caucus room. In addition to networking opportunities, over dinner judges will discuss judging issues. Afterwards there will be another opportunity to visit project displays, including perhaps some projects that were discussed in conversations with your fellow judges during the dinner meeting.

## Wednesday Morning, Judging Day, May 17, 2023

Between 7:00 and 7:40 am, Grand Award judges may view project displays before the students arrive. This is the only such viewing opportunity for judges who registered remotely. After 7:40 am, all Grand Award judges must leave the project display area. You should head to your category's assigned meeting room for breakfast and a training session on interviewing and ISEF procedures led by your category co-chairs.

## Wednesday – First 18 Periods

Beginning at 9:30 am, Grand Award judges will interview students and score projects according to their assigned interview schedule. Each interview period is 15 minutes long, **but that does not mean that interviews are 15 minutes long!** Given the overhead of introducing yourself and getting the *interview proper* started, plus time to extricate yourself from the interview at its end, to record notes and a score for the interview, and to locate your next assigned project, you should plan to use only 10-12 minutes for the interview proper. *It is exceedingly important that all judges stick to their assigned schedules* in order to avoid conflicts with other judges and

demonstrate their professionalism to their assigned students. During your five scheduled breaks, you will have the option of interviewing and scoring two additional projects. During the lunch break in your category meeting room there will almost certainly be some announcements, and you can discuss your sense of the projects with your fellow judges, but there is no official lunch meeting.

### Wednesday – Periods 19 and 20

Shortly after lunch, you will be assigned two additional interviews scheduled in the final two judging periods of the day. These assignments will be based upon your “My5” project choices and projects for which additional interviews are most important.

### Wednesday – Making the Award Decisions

Following Period 20, you will meet with your category caucus to discuss candidate projects and select award winners. Dinner will be provided as your co-chairs lead you through a formal caucusing process to determine all awards informed by your interview observations and a graphical digest of each project’s interview scoring. This caucus can take a few hours so we ask that you anticipate not concluding the evening until 8:00 pm.

## Points of Emphasis

1. You should study all of the projects in your category, starting when these materials are first provided to you ten days before the fair.
2. On Tuesday, you will identify those projects you would like to interview but were not assigned. ISEF uses these “My5” projects to assign interviews during periods 19-20.
3. During the 20 interview periods, you must stick to your interview schedule to avoid problems both with students and with other judges.